



“GREAT TIMES AHEAD FOR INDIA-US PARTNERSHIP”

Piyush Goyal, Minister of Commerce and Industry, on the outlook for India's trade ties with the US under the Trump presidency

BY RAHUL KANWAL

With Donald Trump set to enter the Oval Office as the 47th President of the US in January, trade negotiators the world over are preparing for the new administration's trade policy. India's Commerce and Industry Minister Piyush Goyal is unperturbed. In an interaction with *Business Today* at the BT Most Powerful Women in Business awards in Mumbai, the minister says that he is optimistic about India-US trade considering Trump's warm relationship with Prime Minister Narendra Modi and his proposals to raise tariffs on Chinese imports. Edited excerpts:

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During his campaign, US President-elect Donald Trump called India the tariff king, and you had held discussions with (prospective US Trade Representative Robert) Lighthizer about an India-US trade deal. How do you see Trump's threat of increasing trade tariffs on India impact the balance of trade that is currently in India's favour?

[Trump] may have said once or twice that India has very high tariffs, but a number of times he has praised India and Prime Minister Narendra Modi. He has made it very clear... that he wants to expand business with India; he wants to increase trade with India.

in rural areas and Tier II/III cities, but metros and industrial demand are weak. We believe India's economy has entered a cyclical growth slowdown. We see rising downside risks to our GDP growth projections of 6.7% YoY in FY25 and 6.8% in FY26, both of which are already below the Reserve Bank of India's projections," said a recent Nomura report.

Rajani Sinha, Chief Economist at rating agency CareEdge Group, says the economic slowdown is not as steep as was being projected. "While there was some slowdown in high-frequency data such as PMI, industrial production, [and] IIP in the second quarter of the fiscal, these seem to have shown some improvement in October. However, GST collections and corporate results still show some moderation," she notes.

"There are various factors at play that will impact India's growth this fiscal. While the rural economy



“Current trends suggest that inflation in H2FY25 may exceed RBI's projections, potentially delaying a rate-cutting cycle”

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